

Bereshit

בראשית

This week's value: **Caring for the world** (שְׁמִירָה עַל הָעוֹלָם), “caring for Hashem's world”

The middah and its gesture

Caring for the world: שְׁמִירָה עַל הָעוֹלָם. Gesture: **arms in a big circle: hug the world**. Use it every day this week, every time a child shares a way to help.

How to use this guide

- Each card has a picture on the front and a teacher script on the back. This booklet has one page per card with the background: what the Torah says, what our Sages teach, and what to say if children ask hard questions.
- On the card backs, **bold words are what you SAY**, and **[words in brackets are what you DO]**.
- Use the week plan (p.2): about 15 minutes a day, Monday to Friday, ending on Friday with Shabbat and the home card.
- Cards marked core are the must-do cards. The others are for when you have time.

Reading a card back

Bold = what you say. **[Brackets = what you do.]**

Example: **Day 1: light!** **[Open hands wide]**

On every card page

What the Torah says (with verses) · Our Sages teach · If they ask · See / Do / Join · Extend · Tip

What's inside

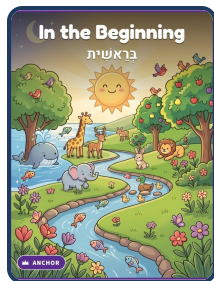
p.1	How to use
p.2	Anchor: In the Beginning
p.3	Bereshit in brief
p.4	Spotlight 1: Adam
p.5	Spotlight 2: Chava
p.6	Day 1: Light
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p.18	Family letter
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The week, day by day

When	Cards (guide page)	Min	Extras that fit
Mon	Anchor: In the Beginning (p.2) ★ · Day 1: Light (p.6) ★ · Day 2: Sky & Water (p.7) ★	11	—
Tue	Day 3: Land & Trees (p.8) ★ · Day 4: Sun & Moon (p.9) ★	6	Listen & Do
Wed	Day 5: Fish & Birds (p.10) ★ · Day 6: Animals & People (p.11) ★ · Spotlight 1: Adam (p.4) ★	10	I-spy in Gan Eden
Thu	Spotlight 2: Chava (p.5) · Connection: Taking Care of Our World (p.13)	8	Match-it (with day ↔ creation set), Bingo
Fri	Day 7: Shabbat (p.12) ★ · Power word: Tov · Good! (p.14) ★ · Home card: This Week: Bereshit (p.18)	6	Coloring: 7 days, Easy coloring (age 4), 7 days strip (age 6), Day order game, Family letter

★ = core card. Extras are in the extras folder; see p.17 for materials and timing.



ANCHOR

In the Beginning

בְּרֵאשִׁית

Week: **Mon**

5 min

core

Goal: Hashem made a beautiful world for us

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:1-2:3

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים

The Torah opens: "In the beginning Hashem created the heavens and the earth" (בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא, Genesis 1:1). Then, day by day, Hashem gave the world its shape: Day 1 light, Day 2 the sky, Day 3 land, seas and plants, Day 4 the sun, moon and stars, Day 5 fish and birds, Day 6 animals and people. Hashem saw everything and it was "very good" (טוֹב מְאֹד, 1:31). On Day 7 Hashem rested (2:1-3). Each story card this week is one day; this picture shows the whole finished world.

Genesis 1:1

Genesis 1:31

Genesis 2:1

Our Sages teach

Rashi teaches that the Torah begins with the story of creation to show that the whole world belongs to Hashem, who made it. That is why we take care of it: it is Hashem's world, lent to us. (*Rashi on Genesis 1:1*)

For the teacher: Ramban teaches that in the very first verse Hashem created everything from nothing. The earth was 'tohu va'vohu' (תוהו ובוהו), empty and without form) with darkness over the deep water (1:2), and the six days then gave it shape. The cards start with the light, so children never meet a dark, empty world. (*Ramban on Genesis 1:1*)

If they ask "Who made Hashem?": the answers are on p.15.

👁️ **See:** Point to the sky, the water, the land, the animals: one finger per thing as you name it. 🙌 **Do:** Children who can't count on fingers can tap their knees seven times instead. 🤝 **Join:** Everyone can do the hug-the-world gesture together, with or without words.

Extend: Start a 7-days chart on the wall: one empty box per day. Each day the class draws or sticks what Hashem made. **Tip:** Practice the hug-the-world gesture (arms in a big circle) for this week's value, 'caring for Hashem's world', and use it every day.

The story

Hashem makes the whole world in six days: light; the sky; dry land, seas and plants; the sun, moon and stars; fish and birds; animals, and then people. After each day Hashem sees that it is good (טוב), and at the end, "very good". On the seventh day Hashem rests and makes that day blessed and holy: Shabbat. Hashem forms Adam from the earth, puts him in Gan Eden "to work it and to guard it", and brings him the animals to name. It is not good for Adam to be alone, so Hashem makes Chava. (Genesis 3, the snake and the fruit, is for the teacher guide only.)

Genesis 1:1–6:8

The heart of it

Wonder: everything is brand new, and it is all good. Our job is to take care of it.

Key moments

Moment	Verses
Let there be light: light breaks into the dark	Genesis 1:3-5
Sky, seas, dry land and the first plants and trees	Genesis 1:6-13
The world fills with life: sun, moon, stars, fish, birds, animals	Genesis 1:14-25
Hashem rests on the seventh day and makes it holy	Genesis 2:1-3
Adam is placed in the garden to work it and guard it	Genesis 2:7, Genesis 2:15
Adam names the animals	Genesis 2:19-20
Hashem makes Chava; Adam is not alone anymore	Genesis 2:18, Genesis 2:21-23

Children understand

Hashem made the whole world in six days and it was all good (tov); on day seven Hashem rested: Shabbat.

Children feel

Wonder at how good and beautiful the world is, and pride in helping to care for it.

Children do

Name one way to take care of Hashem's world (water a plant, be gentle with animals, keep our room tidy) and say TOV with a thumbs up.

The value (middah)

Caring for the world · שמירה על העולם

Kid phrase: "caring for Hashem's world"

Gesture: arms in a big circle: hug the world

Power word

טוב TOV = good · gesture: thumbs up

Not on any card (teacher only)

- the snake and the fruit (Genesis 3:1-7): answer only if asked, see p.15
- leaving Gan Eden (Genesis 3:22-24): answer only if asked, see p.15
- Kayin and Hevel (Genesis 4:1-16): skipped this year



SPOTLIGHT 1

Adam

אָדָם

Week: Wed

4 min

core

Goal: Adam's jobs: care for the garden, name the animals

אָדָם

a-da-MAH = earth

Gesture: cup your hands, scoop the earth

What the Torah says

Genesis 2:7, 2:15, 2:19-20

לַעבֹדָה וּלְשִׁמְרָה

Hashem formed Adam from the dust of the ground (אָדָם, adamah: that's where his name comes from) and breathed the breath of life into him. Hashem put Adam in Gan Eden "to work it and to guard it" (לַעבֹדָה וּלְשִׁמְרָה): the very first job in the world was taking care of the garden. Then Hashem brought every animal and bird to Adam "to see what he would call them", and whatever Adam called each one, that became its name. The snake, the tree and the fruit (Genesis 3) are NOT on any card: if a child asks, use the scripted answers below.

Genesis 2:7

Genesis 2:15

Genesis 2:19-20

Genesis 3:1-7

Our Sages teach

Our Sages teach that Hashem took Adam around all the trees of Gan Eden and said: 'See how beautiful My world is. I made it all for you. Take care not to spoil it, because nobody will come after you to fix it.' Naming the animals was part of caring for them: you look closely at each one.

Kohelet Rabbah 7:13

If they ask...

"Did they eat the fruit? What about the snake?"

Say: Hashem asked Adam and Chava not to eat from one special tree. The snake tricked them, and they ate it: they made a mistake. Hashem still took care of them and even made them clothes.

Then: What can we do when we make a mistake? (Say sorry, try again.)

"Did Adam and Chava have to leave the garden?"

Say: Yes, after the mistake they went to live outside the garden. Hashem gave them clothes and stayed with them, and they kept working the land.

Then: How can we take care of the world right here?

👁️ See

Bring a small pot of real soil, and hold up toy animals (or pictures) one at a time to name.

👏 Do

Children can scoop with one hand, and use a soft roar and a quiet tweet, or show the animal with hands.

👉 Join

Point to Adam on the card, or hold the toy animal while a friend names it.

Extend

Name-it circle: pass a toy animal around; each child gives it a name and one way to take care of it.

Teacher tip

Say אָדָם and אָדָם side by side, slowly, so children hear the shared sound. If a child mentions the snake or the fruit, answer calmly with the script below, then come back to the animals.



SPOTLIGHT 2

Chava

חַוָּה

Week: Thu

3 min

if you have time

Goal: Adam and Chava help each other

עוֹזְרִים

oz-RIM = helping

Gesture: hook your pinkies with a friend

What the Torah says

Genesis 2:18, 2:21-23

Hashem said, "It is not good for the man to be alone; I will make a helper for him." Hashem let Adam sleep and made Chava from a part of Adam's side, then brought her to Adam, and Adam was glad. Later Adam named her Chava (חַוָּה), "because she was the mother of all living things." On the card we say only "Hashem made Chava" (sensitivity reframe); the side detail is here if a child asks.

Genesis 2:18

Genesis 2:21-23

Genesis 3:20

לֹא־טוֹב הָיִיתָ הָאָדָם לְבַדּוֹ

Our Sages teach

Our Sages teach that Hashem began all people with just one person, to teach that every single person is as precious as a whole world.

Mishnah Sanhedrin 4:5 (Sanhedrin 37a)

If they ask...

"How did Hashem make Chava?"

Say: The Torah says Hashem let Adam fall asleep and made Chava from a part of Adam's side, so they would always be close, like a team. It didn't hurt.

Then: Who is on your team at home?

👁️ See

Show the sad face and the happy face with two simple drawn faces held up in turn.

👋 Do

A child who doesn't want to high-five can give a thumbs up or a wave to a friend instead.

🤝 Join

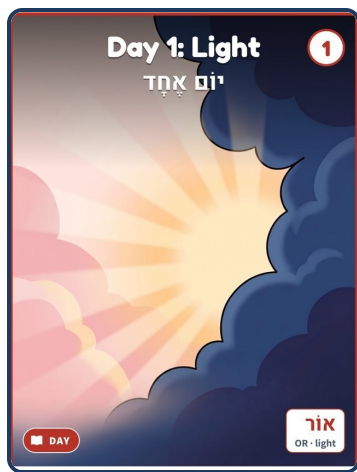
Children can hook pinkies with the teacher, or point to a friend who helps them.

Extend

Helping hands: children trace a hand on paper and the teacher writes one way they helped someone today.

Teacher tip

Keep the 'alone' beat short and light; move quickly to the happy face so nobody feels sad for long.



DAY 1

Light יום אור

Week: Mon

3 min

core

Goal: Day 1: Hashem made light

אור

OR = light

Gesture: fists, then open wide like a sunburst

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:3-5

יהי אור

Hashem said, "Let there be light" (יהי אור, Genesis 1:3), and there was light. Hashem saw that the light was good (כִּי־טוֹב, the 1st TOV), and separated the light from the darkness: Hashem called the light "day" and the darkness "night". There was evening and there was morning, "one day" (יוֹם אֶחָד). The deep water of 1:2 is the world before the days began; the card leaves it out so Day 1 is only light and dark.

Genesis 1:2

Genesis 1:3-5

Our Sages teach

Our Sages teach that the light of Day 1 was a special light, not the sun. Hashem set it aside for the righteous; the sun, moon and stars were put in their places in the sky on Day 4.

Rashi on Genesis 1:4 and 1:14 (Chagigah 12a)

If they ask...

"Is the dark scary?"

Say: The dark is just the time before the light. Hashem made the light, and Hashem made the night too, so we can rest.

Then: Let's close our eyes and open them again: WOW, light!

"Where did the light come from before the sun?"

Say: Hashem made a special light on Day 1. Our Sages teach it was a different light from the sun. The sun and moon came on Day 4.

Then: Show me light with your hands!

👁️ See

Dim the classroom lights at 'It was dark', then switch them on at 'Let there be light!'

👐 Do

Children who don't want to make fists can blink their eyes closed and open instead.

👉 Join

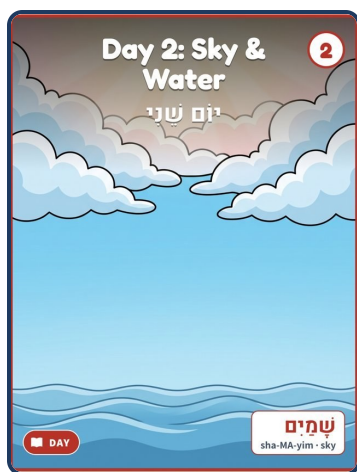
Everyone joins the 'TOV!' thumbs up at the end, with or without words.

Extend

Light walk: turn off the lights and let each child point a flashlight at one thing in the room and name it.

Teacher tip

Start the finger count here: hold up 1 finger. Each day's card adds one gesture, so by Day 7 the class can do all seven.



DAY 2

Sky & Water

יום שני

Week: Mon

3 min

core

Goal: Day 2: the sky, between water and water

שמים

sha-MA-yim = sky

Gesture: reach both arms up high

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:6-8

Hashem said, "Let there be a sky" (יְהִי רָקִיעַ, Genesis 1:6): a great spread (rakia) in the middle of the water, with water above it and water below it. Hashem called the rakia "sky" (שָׁמַיִם). There was evening and morning, the second day. On the card the water up high is drawn as big clouds. This is the one day where the Torah does NOT say "Hashem saw that it was good", so the back has no TOV today.

Genesis 1:6-8

יְהִי רָקִיעַ בְּתוֹךְ הַמַּיִם

Our Sages teach

Rashi asks why the Torah doesn't say 'it was good' on Day 2. He answers that the work with the water was only finished on Day 3, and something not yet finished isn't called good yet. That is why Day 3 says 'it was good' twice.

Rashi on Genesis 1:7

If they ask...

"Why didn't Hashem say TOV today?"

Say: The water job wasn't finished yet! Hashem finished it on Day 3, and then the Torah says TOV two times.

Then: Let's save our thumbs for Day 3!

See

Hold a blue cloth up high (the clouds) and wiggle another one on the floor (the sea).

Do

Seated children reach up with one arm and wiggle the other hand low.

Join

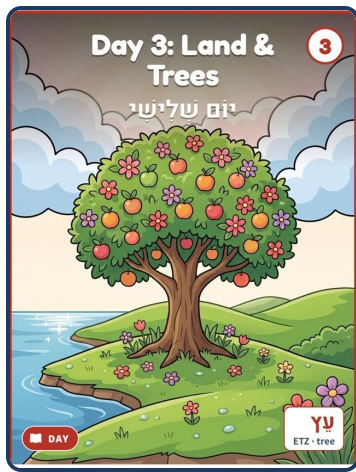
Children can point up for the sky and down for the sea.

Extend

Up-high, down-low game: say 'clouds!' and children wiggle fingers high, 'sea!' wiggle low, 'sky!' reach up. Speed up!

Teacher tip

If children shout TOV out of habit, smile and say: 'The Torah saves it for tomorrow, two times!'



DAY 3

Land & Trees

יום שלישי

Week: Tue

3 min

core

Goal: Day 3: dry land, seas, plants and trees

עץ

ETZ = tree

Gesture: crouch low, then grow up tall with branch arms

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:9-13

Hashem said, "Let the water gather into one place and let the dry land appear" (וַתֵּרָאֶה הַיַּבֶּשֶׁת, Genesis 1:9).

Hashem called the dry land "earth" and the gathered water "seas", and saw that it was good (1:10). Then the earth sprouted grass, plants with seeds and fruit trees (עֵץ פֶּרִי, 1:11-12), and Hashem saw that it was good again. Day 3 has TOV two times: the 2nd and 3rd TOV.

Genesis 1:9-13

וַתֵּרָאֶה הַיַּבֶּשֶׁת

See

Point to the sea, the land and the tree in the picture as you say each one.

Do

Seated children can grow with arms only: hands together low, then branch arms up.

Join

Everyone joins the double thumbs up, with or without words.

Extend

Plant a seed in a clear cup of soil. Each day this week a different child waters it and checks for roots.

Teacher tip

Ask 'What's NEW in this picture?' before you read the back: the tree is the hero, the rest was already there.



DAY 4

Sun & Moon

יום רביעי

Week: Tue

3 min

core

Goal: Day 4: the sun, the moon and the stars

שמש

SHE-mesh = sun

Gesture: open and close your fingers like twinkling light

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:14-19

יהי מארת

Hashem said, "Let there be lights in the sky" (יהי מארת, Genesis 1:14) to separate day from night and to mark days, seasons and years. Hashem made the two great lights (שני המארת הגדלים): the big light for the day and the small light for the night, and the stars (1:16), and saw that it was good (1:18, the 4th TOV).

Genesis 1:14-19

Our Sages teach

Rashi teaches that the sun and moon were made on Day 1, and on Day 4 Hashem put them in their places in the sky.

Rashi on Genesis 1:14 (Chagigah 12a)

If they ask...

"How long was a day before the sun?"

Say: The Torah doesn't tell us how long those first days were. Grown-ups and our Sages have wondered about it a lot! We know Hashem made it all, one step at a time.

Then: What do you see in the sky in the day? At night?

See

Hold up a yellow circle (sun) and a white crescent (moon) as you say each one.

Do

Children who can't twinkle fingers can open and close their hands.

Join

Point to the sun, then the moon, then a star on the card.

Extend

Day or night? Sort pictures (sun, moon, stars, breakfast, pajamas) onto a day side and a night side.

Teacher tip

The sun is the big light, the moon the small light: let children show big and small with their hands.



DAY 5

Fish & Birds

יום חמישי

Week: Wed

3 min

core

Goal: Day 5: fish, sea creatures and birds

דג

DAG = fish

Gesture: palms together, swim them forward

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:20-23

Hashem said, "Let the water swarm with living creatures" (יִשְׂרְצוּ הַמַּיִם, Genesis 1:20), "and let birds fly above the earth, across the sky." Hashem created the great sea creatures (הַתַּיִנִּים הַגְּדֹלִים), every kind of creature in the water and every kind of bird, and saw that it was good (1:21, the 5th TOV). Hashem blessed them: "Have many young and fill the water in the seas."

Genesis 1:20-23

יִשְׂרְצוּ הַמַּיִם

If they ask...

"Did Hashem make sharks and whales too?"

Say: Yes! The Torah says Hashem made the great sea creatures, the giant ones and the tiny ones.

Then: Show me a giant whale swim, and now a tiny fish swim!

See

Show a toy fish and a toy bird, or two pictures, and move each one as you say it.

Do

Children can swim with one hand and flap with the other.

Join

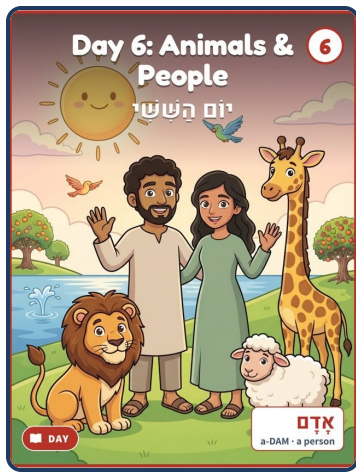
Point to the fish, then the birds on the card.

Extend

Swim or fly? Call out a creature; children swim for sea creatures and flap for birds.

Teacher tip

Keep the whale friendly: a big smile and a gentle splash.



DAY 6

Animals & People

יום הששי

Week: Wed

3 min

core

Goal: Day 6: land animals, then people

אדם

a-DAM = a person (and Adam's name)
Gesture: wave hello

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:24-31

נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם

Hashem said, "Let the earth bring out living creatures" (Genesis 1:24): animals of every kind, and saw that it was good (1:25, the 6th TOV). Then Hashem said, "Let us make people" (נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם, 1:26), and created them in Hashem's image, "male and female He created them" (1:27): so Adam and Chava belong on Day 6. Hashem saw everything and it was "very good" (טוֹב מְאֹד, 1:31, the 7th TOV).

Genesis 1:24-25

Genesis 1:26-28

Genesis 1:31

If they ask...

"Did Hashem make dinosaurs too?"

Say: The Torah says Hashem made every kind of animal, the giant ones and the tiny ones. Dinosaurs lived a very, very long time ago, and Hashem made them too.

Then: Show me a giant dinosaur step, and now a tiny ant step!

👁️ See

Hold up toy animals one at a time; children make each one's sound softly.

👋 Do

Children can choose any movement for their animal: a hop, a stomp, a slither on the hands.

👉 Join

Children who don't want to make a sound can show their animal with hands or point to it on the card.

Extend

Animal parade: each child picks a land animal and moves like it around the circle, then waves hello like Adam and Chava.

Teacher tip

Teach Adam's card on the same day: it tells what Adam did next (cared for the garden and named the animals).



DAY 7

Shabbat

היום השביעי

Week: Fri

3 min

core

Goal: Hashem rested and made Shabbat special

שַׁבָּת

sha-BAT = Shabbat, the rest day

Gesture: hands together under your cheek

What the Torah says

Genesis 2:1-3

The heavens and the earth and everything in them were finished (2:1). On the seventh day Hashem finished the work and rested (וַיִּנְשָׁבֶת, vayishbot, the root of "Shabbat", 2:2). Hashem blessed the seventh day and made it holy (2:3). Nothing new was made on Day 7: the picture is the whole world at rest.

Genesis 2:1-3

וַיִּנְשָׁבֶת בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

If they ask...

"Was Hashem tired?"

Say: Hashem never gets tired. Hashem stopped making new things to show us that one day each week is for resting and enjoying the world.

Then: What do you like to do on Shabbat?

👁️ See

Show two real (unlit) Shabbat candlesticks, or a picture of them.

👐 Do

Children who can't sit still can 'rest' by sitting cross-legged with hands in lap.

👏 Join

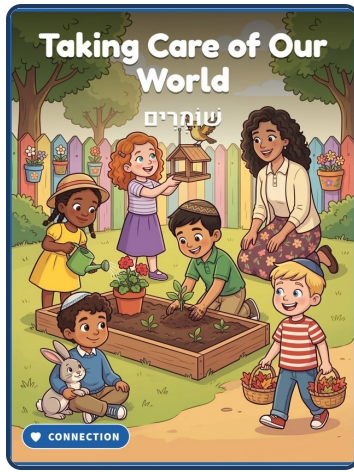
Everyone can join a whispered 'Shabbat Shalom' or wave to the class.

Extend

Rest and notice: one minute of quiet with eyes closed, then each child names one sound they heard.

Teacher tip

Teach this card on Friday: do the 7-gesture chant once slowly, once fast, then a whispered 'Shabbat Shalom'.



CONNECTION

Taking Care of Our World שומרים

Week: Thu 5 min if you have time

Goal: Each child names one way to help

What the Torah says Genesis 2:15

לְעֹבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ

Hashem put Adam in Gan Eden "to work it and to guard it" (לְעֹבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ). The word on this card, שומרים (shomrim, "guarding, taking care"), comes from that verse: we are the guardians of Hashem's world today.

Genesis 2:15

Our Sages teach

Our Sages teach that Hashem told Adam: 'Take care not to spoil My world, because there is no one to fix it after you.'

Kohelet Rabbah 7:13

👁️ See

Show 3 picture cues (watering can, bird feeder, recycling bin) for children who need an idea.

👏 Do

Children can act out their idea (watering, sweeping, feeding) instead of saying it.

👉 Join

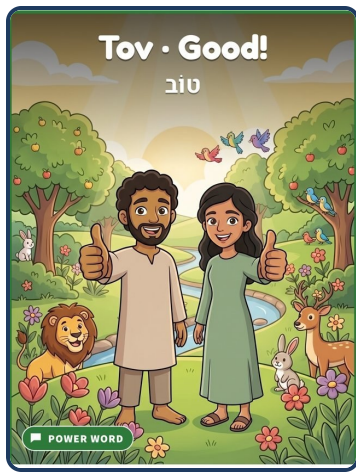
A child can point to one of the picture cues or to a feeling face on the back.

Extend

Make a class 'Shomrim' chart: each child's helping idea, with a sticker each time they do it this week.

Teacher tip

Use the hug-the-world gesture (arms in a big circle) every time a child shares an idea.



POWER WORD

Tov • Good! טוב

Week: Fri

3 min

core

Goal: Say, show, and use the word "tov"

טוב

TOV = good

Gesture: thumbs up

What the Torah says

Genesis 1:31

After making the light, the land and seas, the plants, the sun and moon, the fish and birds, and the land animals, "Hashem saw that it was good" (כִּי־טוֹב). At the very end Hashem saw everything and it was "very good" (טוֹב הָאֵד). That is 7 TOVs in the creation story: none on Day 2, two on Day 3 (Genesis 1:10 and 1:12), and the last one is "very good".

Genesis 1:4

Genesis 1:10

Genesis 1:12

Genesis 1:18

Genesis 1:21

Genesis 1:25

Genesis 1:31

וְהָיָה טוֹב הָאֵד

See

Write טוב big on the board and point to it each time the class says TOV.

Do

Children who can't make a thumbs up can nod or smile big for TOV.

Join

Everyone shows the thumbs up together; no words needed.

Extend

Tov hunt: children find 7 good things in the room and give each one a TOV thumbs up.

Teacher tip

Review this week's words: אֹר (OR, light) and שַׁבָּת (shabat). Say each, then TOV!

If they ask...

These questions are never on a card. If a child asks, answer in one or two calm, honest sentences, then redirect. The family letter (p.18) gives parents the same words, so home and school match.

ANCHOR · WHO MADE HASHEM

“Who made Hashem?”

Say: Nobody made Hashem. Hashem was always here, before everything, and made everything else. That's a big question, and grown-ups wonder about it too!

Then: What is your favorite thing Hashem made?

Genesis 1:1

SPOTLIGHT 1 · THE SNAKE AND THE FRUIT

“Did they eat the fruit? What about the snake?”

Say: Hashem asked Adam and Chava not to eat from one special tree. The snake tricked them, and they ate it: they made a mistake. Hashem still took care of them and even made them clothes.

Then: What can we do when we make a mistake? (Say sorry, try again.)

Genesis 3:1-7

SPOTLIGHT 1 · LEAVING THE GARDEN

“Did Adam and Chava have to leave the garden?”

Say: Yes, after the mistake they went to live outside the garden. Hashem gave them clothes and stayed with them, and they kept working the land.

Then: How can we take care of the world right here?

Genesis 3:21-24

SPOTLIGHT 2 · HOW CHAVA WAS MADE

“How did Hashem make Chava?”

Say: The Torah says Hashem let Adam fall asleep and made Chava from a part of Adam's side, so they would always be close, like a team. It didn't hurt.

Then: Who is on your team at home?

Genesis 2:21-22

DAY 1

“Is the dark scary?”

Say: The dark is just the time before the light. Hashem made the light, and Hashem made the night too, so we can rest.

Then: Let's close our eyes and open them again: WOW, light!

DAY 1

“Where did the light come from before the sun?”

Say: Hashem made a special light on Day 1. Our Sages teach it was a different light from the sun. The sun and moon came on Day 4.

Then: Show me light with your hands!

DAY 2

“Why didn't Hashem say TOV today?”

Say: The water job wasn't finished yet! Hashem finished it on Day 3, and then the Torah says TOV two times.

Then: Let's save our thumbs for Day 3!

DAY 4

“How long was a day before the sun?”

Say: The Torah doesn't tell us how long those first days were. Grown-ups and our Sages have wondered about it a lot! We know Hashem made it all, one step at a time.

Then: What do you see in the sky in the day? At night?

DAY 5

“Did Hashem make sharks and whales too?”

Say: Yes! The Torah says Hashem made the great sea creatures, the giant ones and the tiny ones.

Then: Show me a giant whale swim, and now a tiny fish swim!

DAY 6 · DINOSAURS

“Did Hashem make dinosaurs too?”

Say: The Torah says Hashem made every kind of animal, the giant ones and the tiny ones. Dinosaurs lived a very, very long time ago, and Hashem made them too.

Then: Show me a giant dinosaur step, and now a tiny ant step!

Genesis 1:20-25

DAY 7

“Was Hashem tired?”

Say: Hashem never gets tired. Hashem stopped making new things to show us that one day each week is for resting and enjoying the world.

Then: What do you like to do on Shabbat?

Adaptations & extensions

Every child can take part: **See** (another way to take it in), **Do** (another way to move or answer), **Join** (a way in without speaking).

Card	See	Do	Join	Extend
Anchor p.2	Point to the sky, the water, the land, the animals: one finger per thing as you name it.	Children who can't count on fingers can tap their knees seven times instead.	Everyone can do the hug-the-world gesture together, with or without words.	Start a 7-days chart on the wall: one empty box per day. Each day the class draws or sticks what Hashem made.
Spotlight 1 p.4	Bring a small pot of real soil, and hold up toy animals (or pictures) one at a time to name.	Children can scoop with one hand, and use a soft roar and a quiet tweet, or show the animal with hands.	Point to Adam on the card, or hold the toy animal while a friend names it.	Name-it circle: pass a toy animal around; each child gives it a name and one way to take care of it.
Spotlight 2 p.5	Show the sad face and the happy face with two simple drawn faces held up in turn.	A child who doesn't want to high-five can give a thumbs up or a wave to a friend instead.	Children can hook pinkies with the teacher, or point to a friend who helps them.	Helping hands: children trace a hand on paper and the teacher writes one way they helped someone today.
Day 1 p.6	Dim the classroom lights at 'It was dark', then switch them on at 'Let there be light!'	Children who don't want to make fists can blink their eyes closed and open instead.	Everyone joins the 'TOV!' thumbs up at the end, with or without words.	Light walk: turn off the lights and let each child point a flashlight at one thing in the room and name it.
Day 2 p.7	Hold a blue cloth up high (the clouds) and wiggle another one on the floor (the sea).	Seated children reach up with one arm and wiggle the other hand low.	Children can point up for the sky and down for the sea.	Up-high, down-low game: say 'clouds!' and children wiggle fingers high, 'sea!' wiggle low, 'sky!' reach up. Speed up!
Day 3 p.8	Point to the sea, the land and the tree in the picture as you say each one.	Seated children can grow with arms only: hands together low, then branch arms up.	Everyone joins the double thumbs up, with or without words.	Plant a seed in a clear cup of soil. Each day this week a different child waters it and checks for roots.
Day 4 p.9	Hold up a yellow circle (sun) and a white crescent (moon) as you say each one.	Children who can't twinkle fingers can open and close their hands.	Point to the sun, then the moon, then a star on the card.	Day or night? Sort pictures (sun, moon, stars, breakfast, pajamas) onto a day side and a night side.
Day 5 p.10	Show a toy fish and a toy bird, or two pictures, and move each one as you say it.	Children can swim with one hand and flap with the other.	Point to the fish, then the birds on the card.	Swim or fly? Call out a creature; children swim for sea creatures and flap for birds.
Day 6 p.11	Hold up toy animals one at a time; children make each one's sound softly.	Children can choose any movement for their animal: a hop, a stomp, a slither on the hands.	Children who don't want to make a sound can show their animal with hands or point to it on the card.	Animal parade: each child picks a land animal and moves like it around the circle, then waves hello like Adam and Chava.
Day 7 p.12	Show two real (unlit) Shabbat candlesticks, or a picture of them.	Children who can't sit still can 'rest' by sitting cross-legged with hands in lap.	Everyone can join a whispered 'Shabbat Shalom' or wave to the class.	Rest and notice: one minute of quiet with eyes closed, then each child names one sound they heard.
Connection p.13	Show 3 picture cues (watering can, bird feeder, recycling bin) for children who need an idea.	Children can act out their idea (watering, sweeping, feeding) instead of saying it.	A child can point to one of the picture cues or to a feeling face on the back.	Make a class 'Shomrim' chart: each child's helping idea, with a sticker each time they do it this week.
Power word p.14	Write טוב big on the board and point to it each time the class says TOV.	Children who can't make a thumbs up can nod or smile big for TOV.	Everyone shows the thumbs up together; no words needed.	Tov hunt: children find 7 good things in the room and give each one a TOV thumbs up.
Home card p.18	Send the card home with a small picture of the TOV thumbs so families know the gesture.	Families who can't walk outside can do the tov walk around the home or from a window.	Non-speaking children can show the tov thumbs at the Shabbat table.	Invite families to send a photo or drawing of their favorite thing Hashem made for a class 'Tov Wall'.

All files are letter size. Print at “Actual size” (100%). Cardstock makes cards last longer.

Extra	Cards used	Materials	Min	Best day	File
Listen & Do	Days 3, 4	crayons; one copy per child per level	10	Tue	listen_do.pdf
I-spy in Gan Eden	Days 5, 6	crayons for the coloring version	10	Wed	ispy.pdf
Match-it (with day ↔ creation set)	Days 1–6	cardstock, print double-sided, scissors	15	Thu	match.pdf
Bingo	Days 1–6	pom-poms or counters (not food), cardstock	15	Thu	bingo.pdf
Coloring: 7 days	Days 1–7	crayons, child scissors, glue stick, tape	25	Fri	coloring.pdf p.1-2
Easy coloring (age 4)	Days 1, 3, 5, 7	crayons, child scissors, glue stick	15	Fri	coloring.pdf p.3-4
7 days strip (age 6)	Days 1–7	crayons, child scissors, glue stick	15	Fri	coloring.pdf p.5
Day order game	Days 1–7	cardstock, scissors (teacher cuts)	10	Fri	sequencing.pdf
Family letter	Home card	one copy per family	2	Fri	bereshit-guide.pdf p.18

This week we learned Bereshit

בְּרֵאשִׁית

Dear families, this week we learned the very beginning of the Torah. Here is what to ask, sing and try at home.

We learned

- Hashem made the world in six days: light, sky, land and plants, the sun and moon, fish and birds, animals and people. Every day Hashem said it was TOV, good!
- On the seventh day Hashem rested and made Shabbat special.
- Adam's very first job was to take care of the garden, and he gave every animal a name.

Our value

Caring for the world (שְׁמִירָה עַל הָעוֹלָם): "caring for Hashem's world".

Our gesture: **arms in a big circle: hug the world.** Ask your child to show you!

Our Hebrew word

טוֹב TOV = good

Ask your child to show you the "tov thumbs"!
Also say: **אור** OR (light) · **שַׁבָּת** sha-BAT (Shabbat)

At the Shabbat table, ask

"What is your favorite thing Hashem made?"

"מָה הַדָּבָר הָאֲהוּב עֲלֵיכֶם שֶׁה' בָּרָא?"

Sing

Sing a 7-days counting song to any tune your child knows: hold up one finger for each day, "Day 1, light! Day 2, sky!..." all the way to "Day 7, Shabbat!"

Try at home

Go on a "tov walk": find 7 things Hashem made.

shabbat-friendly

If your child asks about the snake and the fruit

That part of the story isn't on our cards, but children sometimes ask. This is what we say in class:

"Did they eat the fruit? What about the snake?"

Say: Hashem asked Adam and Chava not to eat from one special tree. The snake tricked them, and they ate it: they made a mistake. Hashem still took care of them and even made them clothes.

Then: What can we do when we make a mistake? (Say sorry, try again.)

Shabbat Shalom! · שַׁבָּת שְׁלוֹם

Card	Verses	Our Sages teach
Anchor: In the Beginning	Genesis 1:1, Genesis 1:31, Genesis 2:1	Rashi on Genesis 1:1; Ramban on Genesis 1:1
Spotlight 1: Adam	Genesis 2:7, Genesis 2:15, Genesis 2:19-20, Genesis 3:1-7	Kohelet Rabbah 7:13
Spotlight 2: Chava	Genesis 2:18, Genesis 2:21-23, Genesis 3:20	Mishnah Sanhedrin 4:5 (Sanhedrin 37a)
Day 1: Light	Genesis 1:2, Genesis 1:3-5	Rashi on Genesis 1:4 and 1:14 (Chagigah 12a)
Day 2: Sky & Water	Genesis 1:6-8	Rashi on Genesis 1:7
Day 3: Land & Trees	Genesis 1:9-13	—
Day 4: Sun & Moon	Genesis 1:14-19	Rashi on Genesis 1:14 (Chagigah 12a)
Day 5: Fish & Birds	Genesis 1:20-23	—
Day 6: Animals & People	Genesis 1:24-25, Genesis 1:26-28, Genesis 1:31	—
Day 7: Shabbat	Genesis 2:1-3	—
Connection: Taking Care of Our World	Genesis 2:15	Kohelet Rabbah 7:13
Power word: Tov · Good!	Genesis 1:4, Genesis 1:10, Genesis 1:12, Genesis 1:18, Genesis 1:21, Genesis 1:25, Genesis 1:31	—
Home card: This Week: Bereshit	Genesis 1:1-5, Genesis 2:1-3, Genesis 2:15	—

Commentaries quoted

- Kohelet Rabbah 7:13
- Mishnah Sanhedrin 4:5 (Sanhedrin 37a)
- Ramban on Genesis 1:1
- Rashi on Genesis 1:1
- Rashi on Genesis 1:14 (Chagigah 12a)
- Rashi on Genesis 1:4 and 1:14 (Chagigah 12a)
- Rashi on Genesis 1:7

Hard-question verses (p.15)

Genesis 1:1, Genesis 1:20-25, Genesis 2:21-22, Genesis 3:1-7, Genesis 3:21-24

Texts

Verse texts from Sefaria (<https://www.sefaria.org>), v3 texts API: Metsudah Chumash, Metsudah Publications, 2009 (CC-BY); Tanach with Nikkud (Public Domain). Midrash is labeled “Our Sages teach” and given with its source. Hashem is never drawn as a person in this deck: only light, rays and clouds.